Story of Kevin Mitnick

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Introduction

- Topic: Story of Kevin Mitnick
- Abstract: Kevin Mitnick became the most famous hacker in cybercrime history with a ethical twist.
- Key issues raised: This case brought up the question of cyber security and defenses.

Who was Kevin Mitnick?

- He was born in Van Nuys California, of August 6th 1963.
- Become known as the “World’s’ Most Wanted Hacker”.
- He was an expert on social engineering.
- Codename was Condor.
- Known to be smart and passionate kid for electronics at a young age (Codemotion, n.d.).

What did he do?

- Hacked into major companies including Motorola and other phone companies.
- Stole source code and other sensitive information.
- He managed to avoid the fbi for over two years (EBSCO, n.d.).

How did he Hack?

- Mitnick was very reliant on social engineering.
- He would manipulate employees by pretending to be IT.
- He would also exploit weak authentication systems giving him easy access (Codemotion, n.d.).

Final Hack?

- Mitnick made the mistake of targeting the computer of a highly skilled security expert by the name of Tsutomu Shimomura.
- He stole sensitive files relating to computer security while leaving mocking messages on Shimomura's email.
- Shimomura played a huge factor in tracking kevin leading to his arrest in 1995 (EBSCO, n.d.).

Aftermath Damages

- He was charged with 26 counts of computer, telephone, and wire fraud.
- His hacks resulted in substantial data breaches and financial losses costing around $300,000.
- His case became a symbol of the beginning of hacker culture (EBSCO, n.d.).

In Mitnick’s Defense

- Mitnick along with the public claimed he hacked for fun instead of malicious intent.
- No evidence was found against kevin and no stolen data.
- The public argued that the FBI had more pressing matters rather than prosecuting a trickster (Codemotion, n.d.).

Did his crimes end?

- Mitnick stopped hacking after his arrest in 1995.
- He chose to become a author, consultant, and white hat penetration tester.
- He wanted to shift from hacking into systems to protecting them (EBSCO, n.d.).

Conclusion

- Kevin Mitnick is remembered as one of the most influential hackers.
- His actions not only exposed major weaknesses in corporations but in the government as well.
- He was an security expert helping to defend the systems he once attacked (n.d.).

References

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